

Darwin Core Maintenance Group call

2026-08-03 12:30 UTC

Attendees: Steve Baskauf, John Wieczorek, Kit Lewers, Tim Robertson, Cecilie Svenningsen

Regrets: Ben Norton, Kate Ingenloff

Notes:

- For public review the plan is to have people discuss for 30 days and 30 days of no discussion/disputing; around August 15th, we should go through the issues and tag ones that have consensus
- If we can get this done by the end of October that will allow us to stick to the 4 months/quarterly releases
- Proposal to include eco: and chrono: list of terms to 'main' DwC by MG group decision announced with releases. Before implemented, create a GH issue informing the community of the pending change

The next meeting should be on 7 September 2026 (the first Monday) at 12:30 UTC.

- I. Ongoing public review (see https://dwc.tdwg.org/public_review/) :
 - A. The timeline is as follows:
 1. First month: 30 days of discussion (16 July - 15 August)
 2. Second month: 30 day quiet period for issues that have achieved consensus (16 August - 15 September) followed by Executive Committee approval (hopefully first Exec meeting after 15 September).
 3. Third month: implement changes and publish. Release new version of DwC. If possible, compress between 15 September and 1 October to get us on the regular schedule.
 4. Fourth month: legwork to prepare for the next public review, changes to be vetted at 5 October DwC MG meeting with next public review announced around 1 November.
 - B. Discussion of status of review
- II. Proposal to simplify Darwin Core vocabularies by folding eco: and chrono: vocabularies into the main DwC vocabulary
 - A. Presentation by Steve
 - B. Discussion, in particular whether the MG thinks this is something they can and should do.
- III. Status of [schema maintenance](#)
 - A. DwC-DP profile and table schemas
 1. Dev and review location dwc branch of [rs.tdwg.org](https://github.com/tdwg/rs.tdwg.org/tree/dwc/dwc-dp/1.0_DEV/table-schemas)
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 - B. DwC-A XML schemas

1. [Script](#) on rs.gbif.org generates DwC-A XML [schemas](#)
 2. Script and schemas on rs.gbif.org need to move to [rs.tdwg.org](#). See <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/930#issuecomment-5158534787>
 3. DNA-derived extension not scripted and not generated for 2026-05-26 version (this should be added as soon as possible). See <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/1039>
 4. Decisions needed on [additional XML schemas](#) (this can wait for a future public review)
- C. Landing page(s) needed DwC-DP [Issue 929](#) and DwC-A [Issue 930](#). Decision: Only one landing page for all schemas is needed. This page should explain how the schemas fit into the standard, where they can be found, and how they are managed.
- IV. Initial comment editing in public review issues. Good practice is to create a comment to summarize a long issue history when there is either
- A. an apparent consensus that would be useful for people to assess, updating the first comment that introduces the proposal, and documents any changes made to the original issue comment
 - B. a complex discussion with unresolved issues, to explain the state and what still need to be resolved
- V. dcterms:Location dwc:Location does not exist. References to the existing term MUST be dcterms:Location. There is no apparent reason to create a new dwc:Location term.
- VI. Other business